12.2.2 Building a data model

In section 12.1.4 I showed an overview of how EF Core builds up its internal model of your database from the `DbContext` and entity models. Apart from this discovery mechanism, EF Core is flexible in letting you define your entities the way you want to, as POCO classes.

Some ORMs require your entities to inherit from a specific base class or require you to decorate your models with attributes that describe how to map them. EF Core heavily favors a convention over configuration approach, as you can see in listing 12.2, which shows the `Recipe` and `Ingredient` entity classes for your app.

TIP The `required` keyword, used on several properties in listing 12.2, was introduced in C# 11. It's used here to prevent warnings about uninitialized non-nullable values. You can read more about how EF Core interacts with non-nullable types in the documentation at http://mng.bz/Keoj.

Listing 12.2 Defining the EF Core entity classes

```
public class Recipe
{
    public int RecipeId { get; set; }
    public required string Name { get; set; }
    public TimeSpan TimeToCook { get; set; }
    public bool IsDeleted { get; set; }
    public required string Method { get; set; }
    public required ICollection<Ingredient> Ingredients { get; set; }    ❶
}
public class Ingredient
{
    public int IngredientId { get; set; }
    public int RecipeId { get; set; }
    public required string Name { get; set; }
    public decimal Quantity { get; set; }
    public required string Unit { get; set; }
}
```